



Standard Operating Procedure

HR Executives & Support Team — Operations Handbook

LadderStep Human Consulting · Recruitment & Outreach Platform

Version 2.1 (Detailed & Illustrated) · Last updated 5 July 2026

Covers: all login types · complete application flow · every executive workflow · step-by-step playbooks

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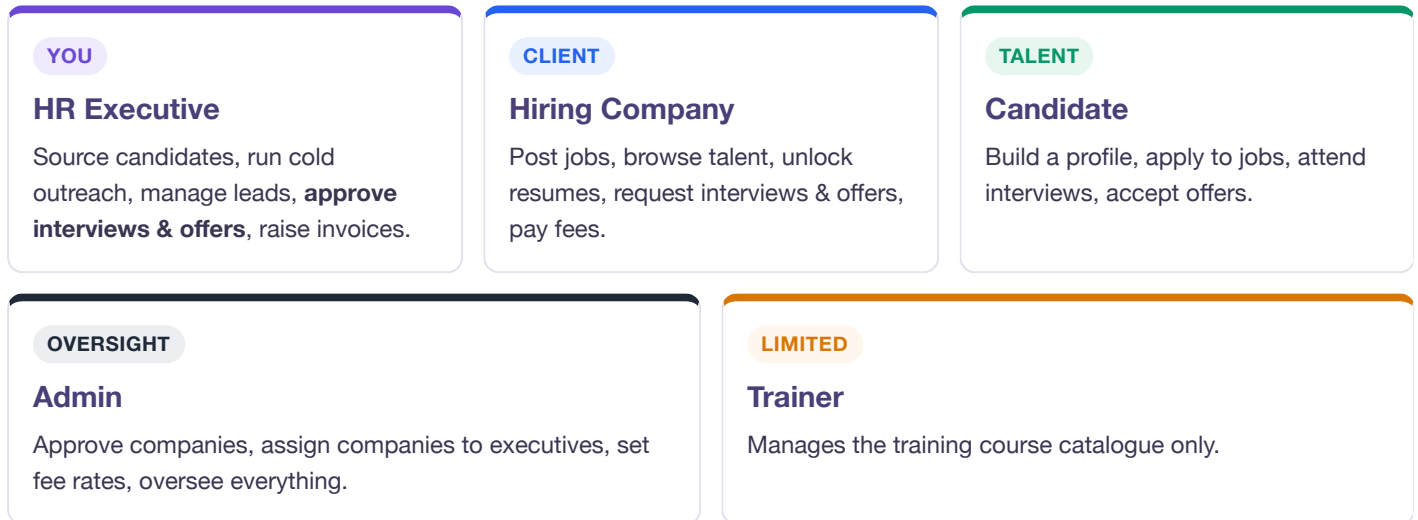
1. **Part A — Understand the Platform:** what it is, the 5 portals, how money flows
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5. **Part E — Rules, Locks, Money & Reference:** business rules, do's/don'ts, FAQ, glossary
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■ HR Executive ■ Hiring Company ■ Candidate ■ Admin ■ System / Automatic

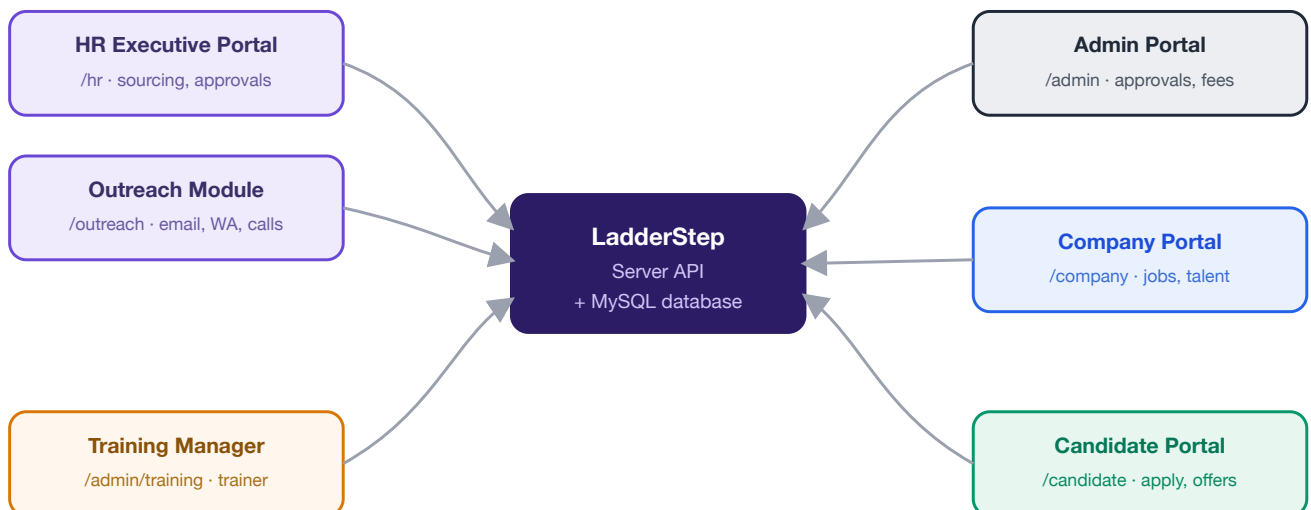
Part A · Understand the Platform

A1. What LadderStep is

LadderStep Human Consulting is an end-to-end **recruitment + HR outreach platform**. It brings four kinds of users onto one system and moves a candidate from "sourced" all the way to "hired & paid for."



A2. The five portals & how they connect

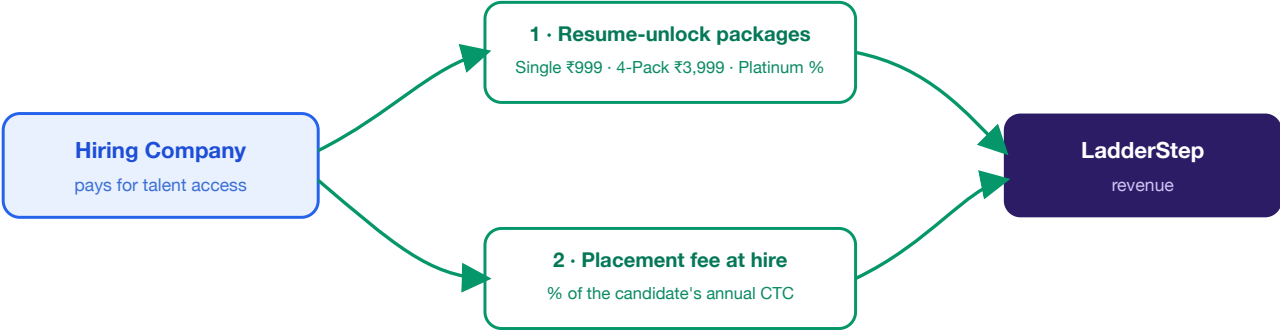


Every portal talks to one shared server + database. Your role decides which portal you land in.

Portal	URL	Who can enter
HR Portal	/hr	HR Executive, Admin
Outreach	/outreach	HR Executive, Admin
Company Portal	/company	Hiring Company
Candidate Portal	/candidate	Candidate
Admin Portal	/admin	Admin, Trainer

Admins can visit the HR Portal too. They see an "Admin View" banner with a "← Admin Dashboard" link to get back.

A3. How LadderStep earns money (know this early)



Candidates never pay. Companies pay in two ways — and your approvals unlock stream #2.

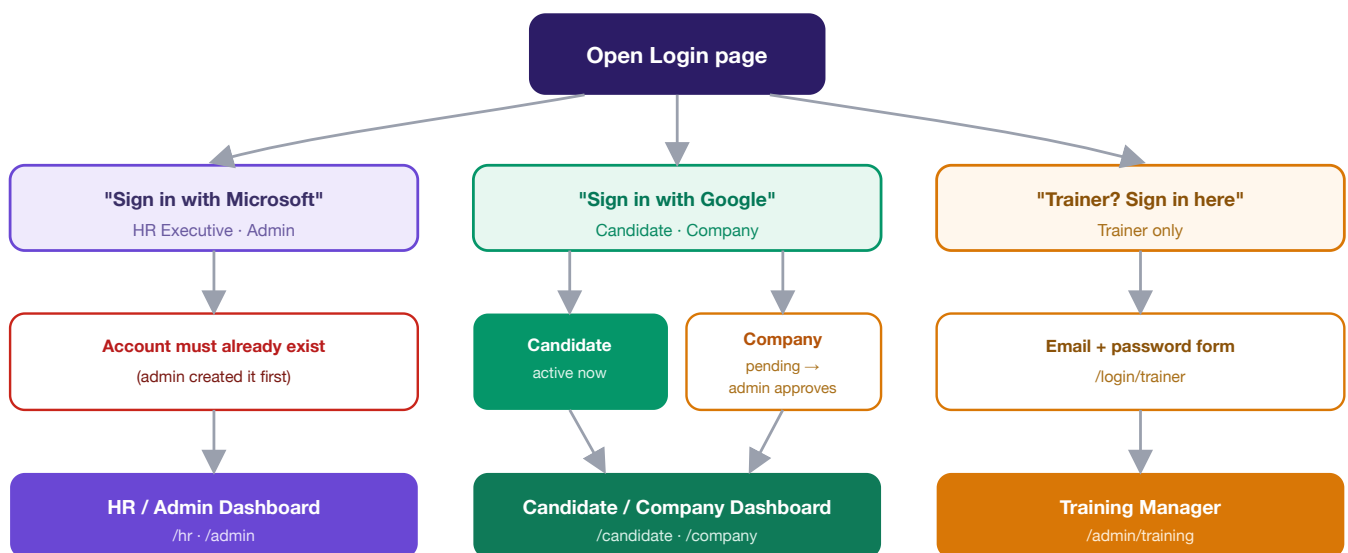
Your two approvals (interview & offer) are what secure the placement fee. That is why the system will not let a company schedule an interview or send an offer without you. Guard these gates.

Part B · Login & Access — every login type

Login is **Single Sign-On (SSO)** for almost everyone. Passwords are retired except for Trainers. The login page shows two buttons — **Sign in with Microsoft** and **Sign in with Google** — plus a small "**Trainer? Sign in here**" link.

Role	Login method	Account created by	First-login behaviour
HR Executive	Microsoft 365 SSO	Admin pre-creates it	Must already exist 🔒
Admin	Microsoft 365 SSO	Another admin creates it	Must already exist 🔒
Candidate	Google SSO	Self, on first login	Active instantly ✅
Company	Google SSO	Self, on first login	Waits for admin approval ⌚
Trainer	Email + password	Admin creates it	Uses "Trainer? Sign in here"

B1. The login decision — one picture



One page, three doors. Nobody chooses their portal — the role behind the account decides.

B2. HR Executive & Admin — Microsoft 365

1. Login page → **Sign in with Microsoft**.
2. Use the Microsoft 365 account **whose email matches the account an admin created for you**.
3. You land on the HR Dashboard (`/hr`); admins land on `/admin` .

🔒 **No self-registration.** A Microsoft sign-in with an unknown email is rejected — this stops strangers from creating privileged accounts. "Account not found" means an admin must add you first.

Provisioning a new executive (Admin does this)

Admin Portal → **HR Staff Management** → **Add Staff** → name + the **exact email** they will sign in to Microsoft with → the system creates a bare account and emails them → they click "Sign in with Microsoft" using that same email. Done.

B3. Candidate — Google (instant)

Login/Register → **Sign in with Google** → Google supplies verified name + email → first-timers are created and **activated instantly** → straight to </candidate>. No approval needed.

Sourced candidates rarely log in. When you bulk-upload résumés (Part D), the system creates their account automatically, but they usually never sign in. That's expected — you act on their behalf.

B4. Company — Google + admin approval



A company cannot use the portal until an admin approves it. At approval the admin also sets whether they are **Platinum** (a contracted placement-fee %) — this drives all later fee maths (Part D6).

B5. Trainer — email + password

Login page → **"Trainer? Sign in here"** → email + password (set by the admin) → lands on Training Manager (</admin/training>). This is the only role with a password.

B6. Login troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Microsoft says "account not found"	Not pre-provisioned / wrong email	Admin adds your exact work email in HR Staff Management
Company sees "pending approval"	Not yet approved	Admin approves in Company Approvals
Candidate can't find password field	Candidates use Google only	Use "Sign in with Google"
Landed in a portal you didn't expect	Each role has exactly one home	This is correct behaviour

Part C · The Complete Application Flow

This is the **entire journey**, from a cold prospect to a paid placement. Colour tells you who acts at each stage. Your two mandatory gates are stages 7 and 8.

- 1 Cold Outreach** HR Executive
You email / WhatsApp / call prospective client companies from the **Outreach** module.
System: replies captured automatically → can become leads
- 2 Lead** HR Executive
A reply becomes a **Lead** in your pipeline. You nurture it: **new → contacted → interested → proposal → converted**.
- 3 Company onboarded** Company Admin
The lead signs up (Google). **Admin approves** them and sets their package / Platinum rate.
Admin also assigns the company to an executive (usually you)
- 4 Job posted** Company
The company posts one or more **job descriptions (JDs)**.
- 5 Sourcing** HR Executive
You bulk-upload résumés against the JD or from the free pool. Each candidate gets a parsed profile and a **fit score**.
System: parses name, experience, education, skills; computes fit score
- 6 Discovery & interest** Company
The company browses the Talent Pool. They either **Unlock** a candidate (Single/4-Pack) or **Express Interest** (→ lands in your *Company Interests* tab).
- 7 Interview — GATE 1** You approve
Company **requests** an interview → **you approve** → the slot is created. For sourced candidates you also **confirm on their behalf**.
🔒 Company cannot create slots directly — approval is mandatory
- 8 Offer — GATE 2** You approve
Company **requests offer-letter release** (with annual CTC) → **you approve** → offer letter is unlocked **and the placement-fee invoice is raised** (unless prepaid).
- 9 Hire** Candidate
The candidate accepts. Status becomes **hired** → they are locked **off the market** everywhere.
- 10 Payment** Company
The company pays the placement fee (Cashfree, full or partial). You track it on Offer Requests / Invoices.

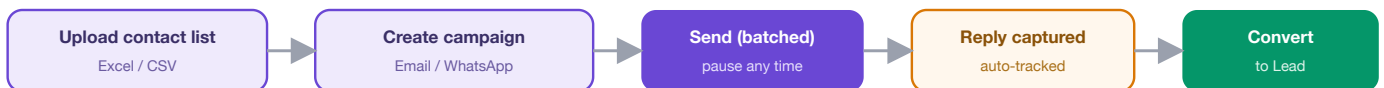
Part D · Executive Workflows in Detail

D1. Your HR Portal map

Screen	What it's for
Dashboard	Your KPIs — leads, tasks, calls, conversions
Lead Pipeline	Your sales leads & their stages
Tasks	Work assigned to / by you
Resume Sourcing	Upload résumés, manage the pool, assign candidates to jobs
Interview Requests	GATE 1 — approve/reject company interview requests
Scheduled Interviews	Confirmed interviews; confirm on behalf of sourced candidates
Offer Requests	GATE 2 — approve offer-letter release (triggers placement fee)
Invoices	Raise & track service invoices for your companies
Reports	Call, lead & productivity reports

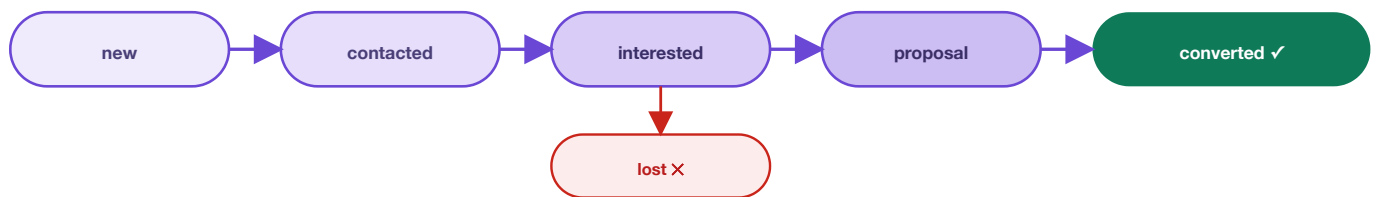
Scoping: you see **your own** leads, calls, replies and the companies **assigned to you**. Admins see everything.

D2. Cold Outreach (Outreach module)



- **Contact Lists:** upload Excel/CSV. Rows with no email *and* no phone are skipped; duplicates removed.
- **Email Campaigns:** personalise with merge tags — `{{first_name}}`, `{{company_name}}`, `{{designation}}`, `{{city}}`, `{{executive_name}}`. Sends 20 at a time; pausable.
- **WhatsApp:** use Meta-approved templates, then a WhatsApp campaign.
- **Replies:** reply inline, **Convert to Lead**, or Ignore. **Cold Calls** and **Analytics** round out the module.

D3. Lead pipeline – the stages



A lead can drop to "lost" from any stage. "Converted" is your sales win; the admin then onboards the company.

D4. Resume Sourcing – four tabs

1 · Upload Résumés

Two modes: 🎯 **Target a Job** (adds applicants + fit scores) or 📁 **Free Pool** (no JD). Up to 20 files, PDF/DOC/DOCX, 5 MB each.

2 · Free Pool

Every available candidate, independent of any job. Search by skill/experience. Click a name → full profile. Hired candidates excluded.

3 · Assign from Pool

Pick a JD → **every** candidate shows a live % **fit** against it. Assign the good ones with one click.

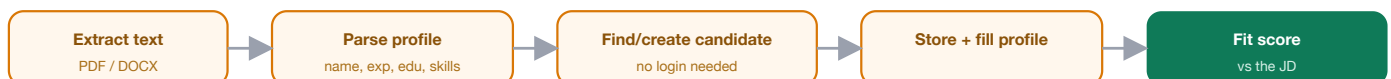
4 · Company Interests

Company "Express Interest" requests land here. Review → assign to their JD → **Assign & Notify**. Blocked if candidate is hired.

🔍 **Click any candidate to open their full profile.** From any tab (or the upload history), clicking a candidate opens a side panel with their **real name, email, phone, LinkedIn, skills (with proficiency), education, experience, and résumés on file**. When you opened it from a job context, the panel also shows the **fit score** for that JD plus the exact **matched** and **missing** skills — so you can judge suitability before assigning.

💯 **Live match scoring.** In **Assign from Pool**, once you pick a JD every pool candidate gets a colour-coded % **fit** badge (green ≥70, amber ≥40, red below) — computed on the spot from their skills vs the JD, even for candidates who haven't applied. Use it to shortlist the strongest matches fast.

What happens automatically to each uploaded résumé



📄 **Name résumés for accurate parsing.** Use `Serial - Name - Designation - X Yrs Y Month.pdf`, e.g. `93_-_Seshu_Adusumilli_-_Manager_HR_-_17_Yrs_0_Month.pdf`. The system reads the candidate's **name & total experience straight from the filename**, which is far more reliable than scraping the document body.

What the company sees vs you: you always see full, unmasked details. The company sees **masked** data (initials, no contact) until they **unlock** the candidate (Part D7).

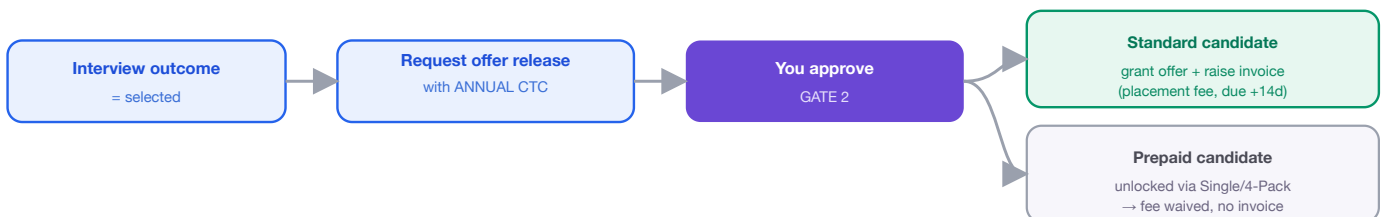
D5. Interview approval — GATE 1 (swimlane)



Companies cannot create interview slots. The only way a slot exists is your approval. You see a request if the company is **assigned to you** OR you **sourced** that candidate.

Confirm on behalf: sourced candidates never log in, so in **Scheduled Interviews** you confirm their slot for them. The view flags "never logged in" + "executive-sourced" and shows real contact details so you can reach them.

D6. Offer & placement fee — GATE 2



How the placement fee is calculated (at submit time)

PLATINUM

Contracted %

$$\text{fee} = \text{annual CTC} \times (\text{percent} \div 100)$$

e.g. 8.33 % $\approx$ one month's salary

DEFAULT

No contracted rate

$$\text{fee} = (\text{annual CTC} \div 12) \times \text{multiplier}$$

multiplier is in months (default = 1)

PREPAID

Single / 4-Pack unlock

Fee waived. No invoice, no fee messaging to the company.

Everything downstream reads the ANNUAL CTC. The company input, your Offer Requests screen, and admin screens all say "Annual CTC." The company then pays via Cashfree (full or partial) and you track it on Offer Requests / Invoices.

D7. What the company experiences — resume-unlock packages

Before a company can browse the Talent Pool or see match %, they must pick a package. Know these three tiers so you can advise clients:

₹999 Single 1 unlock credit. Reveals the real résumé + contact. No placement fee later (prepaid).	₹3,999 4-Pack 4 credits, no expiry. Same reveal as Single. No placement fee later (prepaid).	CONTRACTED % Platinum Free, unlimited unlocks — but résumé stays masked; reach the candidate through you; placement fee applies at hire.
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Companies see AI match % too. In their Talent Pool a company can pick one of their own jobs from a "🎯 **Match against job**" selector and every candidate shows a live **% match** — available to **all** companies regardless of package. This mirrors what you see in **Assign from Pool**, so you and the client are looking at the same scores.

D8. The "off the market" locks

 Pending-offer lock Candidate has a sent/accepted offer. → Removed from Talent Pool; cannot be unlocked or pulled into another pipeline.	 Hired lock Any application reaches "hired". → Locked from ALL activity: sourcing, shortlisting, new applications, everywhere.
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These are automatic. If you can't act on a candidate, check whether one of these locks applies — you'll see "Hired — off market" / "Hired elsewhere — unavailable" badges.

Part E · Rules, Do's & Don'ts, FAQ, Glossary

E1. Roles & responsibilities at a glance

Action	Executive	Company	Candidate	Admin
Run outreach / manage leads	✓	—	—	✓
Approve a company account	—	—	—	✓
Set Platinum fee %	—	—	—	✓
Post a job	—	✓	—	—
Source / assign candidates	✓	—	—	✓
Unlock a résumé	—	✓	—	—
Approve interview	✓	—	—	✓
Approve offer / raise fee	✓	—	—	✓
Accept an offer	—	—	✓	—
Pay a fee	—	✓	—	—

E2. Do's & Don'ts

✓ Do

Name sourced résumés **Serial – Name – Designation – X Yrs Y Month**.

Approve interview & offer requests promptly.

Use "Confirm on behalf" for sourced candidates.

Convert genuine outreach replies into leads.

Open "View Profile" before assigning to a JD.

✗ Don't

Promise a company they can self-schedule interviews or offers — the system blocks it.

Re-source a candidate who is hired or has a pending offer.

Share contact details of a candidate the company hasn't unlocked.

Quote placement fees from memory — the app computes them from annual CTC.

E3. Quick FAQ

Question	Answer
Company can't schedule an interview	Correct — they submit a request and you approve it (Interview Requests).
Sourced candidate can't confirm interview	They never log in — use Scheduled Interviews → Confirm on behalf .
A candidate vanished from the pool	They have a pending offer or are hired — auto-removed.
Company hired but no fee appears	Candidate was unlocked via Single/4-Pack (prepaid) — fee waived by design.
I can't see a company's requests	You only see companies assigned to you (+ candidates you sourced). Ask an admin.
New teammate can't log in with Microsoft	Admin must add them in HR Staff Management with their exact sign-in email.

E4. Glossary

Term	Meaning
JD	Job Description / job posting created by a company
Talent Pool	Searchable set of available (non-hired) candidates
Fit score	AI-computed % match between a candidate and a job
Unlock	A company paying to reveal a candidate's real contact info
Platinum	Company on a contracted placement-fee %; free unlimited unlocks
Placement fee	Fee billed to a company at hire, based on annual CTC
Prepaid candidate	Unlocked via Single/4-Pack — no placement fee at hire
Confirm on behalf	Executive confirming an interview slot for a sourced candidate who never logs in
Off the market	Candidate locked from activity due to a pending offer or a hire
Assigned executive	The HR executive responsible for a given company
GATE 1 / GATE 2	Your mandatory interview-approval and offer-approval steps

Part F · Step-by-Step Playbooks

Click-by-click instructions for everything you do. Each playbook names the screen it starts on (the violet chip) and lists the exact steps in order.

F0. First time in — logging in

Login page

Log in as an HR Executive

You must have been added by an admin first (with your exact work email).

1. Open the app's **Login** page.
2. Click **“Sign in with Microsoft.”**
3. Choose/enter the Microsoft 365 account whose email **matches the one an admin registered** for you.
4. You land on the **HR Dashboard** (</hr>). If you see “account not found,” ask an admin to add you in **HR Staff Management**.

A · OUTREACH & LEADS

Outreach → Contact Lists

1 · Upload a contact list

1. Go to **Outreach** → **Contact Lists** → **Upload**.
2. Select your Excel/CSV file (columns like Name, Email, Phone, Company, Designation, City are auto-mapped).
3. Wait for the import to finish — rows with no email *and* no phone are skipped and listed in the import report; duplicates are removed.

Outreach → Email Campaigns

2 · Send a cold email campaign

1. **Outreach** → **Email Campaigns** → **New**.
2. Pick a contact list, write the **subject** and **body**. Personalise with tags: `{{first_name}}`, `{{company_name}}`, `{{designation}}`, `{{city}}`, `{{executive_name}}`.
3. Click **Save** (draft), review, then **Send**. It sends in batches of 20; use **Pause** to stop mid-send.
4. Track opens/replies under the campaign and in **Replies**.

Outreach → Replies

3 · Turn a reply into a lead

1. Open **Outreach** → **Replies** and click a reply (it auto-marks as read).
2. Choose an action: **Reply** (threaded), **Convert to Lead**, or **Ignore**.
3. **Convert to Lead** creates the lead in your pipeline and links the contact — now nurture it in **Lead Pipeline**.

HR → Lead Pipeline

4 • Move a lead through the pipeline

1. Open **HR → Lead Pipeline** and click a lead.
2. Log calls, add notes, and change the **stage**: **new → contacted → interested → proposal → converted** (or **lost**).
3. When the client agrees to onboard, they sign up with Google and an **admin approves** them.

B • SOURCING CANDIDATES

HR → Resume Sourcing → Upload Résumés

5 • Source résumés against a job

1. **HR → Resume Sourcing → Upload Résumés** → choose 🎯 **Target a Job**.
2. Select the client's active job from the list.
3. Drag & drop up to **20 résumés** (PDF/DOC/DOCX, 5 MB each). Name them **Serial – Name – Designation – X Yrs Y Month.pdf** for accurate parsing.
4. Click **Upload**. Each résumé is parsed, a candidate is created, and a **fit score** is computed. Watch progress in **Upload History**.

HR → Resume Sourcing → Upload Résumés

6 • Add résumés to the free pool (no job yet)

1. Same screen → choose 🗑️ **Free Talent Pool**.
2. Drag & drop the résumés and click **Upload**.
3. Candidates are parsed and land in the **Free Pool / Assign from Pool** tabs, ready to match to a JD later.

HR → Resume Sourcing (any tab)

7 • Review a candidate's full profile & fit

1. In any tab (Free Pool, Assign from Pool, Company Interests) or the upload history, **click the candidate's name / “View Profile.”**
2. A side panel opens with **name, email, phone, LinkedIn, skills, education, experience, and résumés**.
3. If you opened it against a job, you'll also see the **fit score** and the exact **matched** vs **missing** skills — use this to decide before assigning.

HR → Resume Sourcing → Assign from Pool

8 • Assign a pool candidate to a job

1. Open **Assign from Pool** and pick the client **job** on the left.
2. Every candidate now shows a live % **fit** badge (green/amber/red). Filter by skill/experience if needed.
3. Click **Assign to JD** on a strong match — the candidate becomes an applicant on that job.

9 • Action a company's "Express Interest"

1. Open the **Company Interests** tab (the count shows unread requests).
2. Click **View Profile** to check the candidate.
3. Select one of that company's open jobs → **Assign & Notify**. (Blocked with a red flag if the candidate was hired elsewhere — propose an alternative.)

C • APPROVALS (YOUR REVENUE GATES)

10 • Approve (or reject) an interview request — GATE 1

1. Open **HR → Interview Requests** (your pending queue).
2. Click a request to see the proposed date/time, mode, and notes.
3. Choose **Approve**, **Reject**, or **Reschedule**. On **Approve**, the interview slot is created and the company + candidate are notified.

11 • Confirm an interview for a sourced candidate

1. Open **HR → Scheduled Interviews**. Sourced candidates are flagged "**never logged in.**"
2. Use their real contact details shown there to reach out and confirm the time.
3. Click **Confirm on behalf** to confirm the slot for the candidate.

12 • Approve an offer & raise the placement fee — GATE 2

1. Open **HR → Offer Requests** and click the offer-letter-release request (it shows the offered **annual CTC**).
2. Review, then **Approve**. This unlocks the offer letter for the company **and** raises the placement-fee invoice (due in 14 days).
3. If the candidate was **prepaid** (unlocked via Single/4-Pack), the fee is auto-waived and no invoice is raised — nothing more to do.

D • BILLING

13 • Raise & track an invoice

1. Open **HR → Invoices**. Placement-fee invoices from approved offers appear automatically.
2. To raise a service invoice, create one and pick the company (only companies **assigned to you** appear).
3. Track **amount paid / status / due date** — the company pays via Cashfree on their Payments page; the bar updates as they pay (partial or full).